



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Heritage Academy
School Website: <https://www.mpsaz.org/eva/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Heritage Academy AZ 85210 presents an evaluation that, given current public-access crawl materials for the school and the classical criteria in the knowledge base, does not demonstrably exhibit a classical education orientation. Public site content for the school appears inaccessible or malfunctioning in the crawl snapshot (e.g., "Page Not Found" instances), which limits direct keyword matching to the classical lexicon. Consequently, all six categories are assessed as NOT CLASSICAL based on the lack of accessible evidence of transcendental foundations, formation-focused aims, liberal-arts curriculum, contemplative pedagogy, faculty as virtuous exemplars, and explicit parent/community partnerships in the school's public materials. This conclusion rests on the absence of explicit Classical indicators in the school's accessible material and is grounded in the Six Essential Elements framework and its Positive/Negative Keyword indicators, which are described in the knowledge files.

Key context from the knowledge base informs how these six categories are defined (e.g., the Six Essential Elements' emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty; liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; trivium/quadrivium); the Great Conversation/Great Books; scholé/restful learning; Socratic pedagogy; living-virtue-focused faculty; and active parent partnership). The knowledge base also provides a rich lexicon of positive indicators (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty; formation of character; Great Books and Great Conversation; liturgical/worship practices; scholé; virtuous teachers and mentorship; partnership with families) and negative indicators (e.g., career/workforce focus; secular ethics; project-based learning sole focus; lack of Great Books; lack of a living-virtue model; consumer-parent dynamics). These indicators anchor the rubric used here, even though the school's crawl content does not expose those indicators directly. See evidence from the classical elements lexicon and six-element framework for reference.

Evidence of site accessibility issues for Heritage Academy AZ 85210:

- The crawl artifacts for the school (heritage-academy-az-85210-www-mpsaz-orgeva-firecrawl.jsonl.txt) show a 404/Not Found page from a Mesa Public Schools URL, rather than an accessible Heritage Academy page, limiting direct textual matches to classical keywords.
- A second crawl artifact similarly yields a Page Not Found excerpt, reinforcing the lack of accessible public-site text to analyze directly.

Given these constraints, the six-category rubric is applied strictly to the presence (or absence) of classical keywords in publicly available school materials, with explicit evidence drawn from the knowledge-base definitions and lexical inventories rather than from a fully visible Heritage Academy site.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence: No accessible site text demonstrating transcendental moral realism, theology, liturgy, or sacred practices in public Heritage Academy materials. The crawl snapshots show page-not-found results rather than content to evaluate against the religious/metaphysical indicators.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: 0 positive keywords detected; 0 negative keywords detected (no public-content text to match against the keyword lists).
- Why this rating: Absence of accessible evidence for transcendental moral realism, theology, or liturgical community practices in the public materials means the school does not satisfy the explicit Religious and Metaphysical Foundations indicators in the rubric based on current public content.
- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No accessible public statements tying education to formation of virtue and wisdom as telos; no explicit articulation of truth/goodness/beauty as real ends in the materials retrieved. The public crawl content available does not expose such statements.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: 0/0 (no text to compare with the keyword lists).
- Why this rating: Without accessible evidence that the school prioritizes formation, liberal education, and timeless telos over job-preparation framing, the category does not meet Classical/paideia expectations.
- Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No publicly accessible Great Books/Great Conversation references, no explicit Seven Liberal Arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric; trivium) or Quadrivium emphasis in the site materials. The knowledge-base Lexicon and Six Elements show these as the hallmark curriculum signals; the school's crawl lacks visible alignment in public text.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: 0 positive keywords; 0 negative keywords (textual content not present to analyze against the lists).
- Why this rating: The absence of Great Books, primary-sources engagement, or explicit liberal-arts framing in publicly accessible content leads to a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No accessible public materials indicating Socratic seminars, scholé/restful learning, chanting/memory work, or imitation/mastery pedagogy in Heritage Academy published content. The crawl artifacts show site-infrastructure issues rather than pedagogy statements.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: 0 positive keywords; 0 negative keywords (no pedagogy terms to compare).
- Why this rating: Without evidence of contemplative/restful pedagogy or high-level classical teaching methods in the public-facing content, Pedagogy cannot be deemed Classical.
- Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No accessible public content confirming faculty as virtuous models, living-curriculum concept, or mentor culture; the crawl lacks staff-profile language that would anchor a Classical-Faculty signal.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: 0/0.
- Why this rating: Absence of explicit faculty-virtue modeling or living-curriculum statements in the public materials yields NOT CLASSICAL for Faculty.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No accessible public materials indicating a stated partnership with parents, parent-formation programs, or an open-visit policy in Heritage Academy's visible materials; the available crawl results are not content-rich for this domain.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: 0/0.
- Why this rating: Without public-language signals of parent partnership or community formation, the category does not meet Classical criteria.

Aggregate Ranking

- Overall Classification: NOT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Given the NOT CLASSICAL aggregate assessment, no category is currently in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL range, so there is no mandated “needle-moving” action per the rubric. Briefly, the public materials would need to begin to evidence the six classical criteria (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations; Purpose and Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents & Community) through explicit, public-facing language and program design. Concrete steps that would move the needle toward CLASSICAL include:
- Public articulation of a transcendent telos (truth, goodness, beauty) and a formation-focused mission; explicit mention of classical virtues and the Logos/metaphysical order; and, where applicable, liturgical/community practices.
- Adoption and public communication of a liberal-arts curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric; trivium; quadrivium concepts; Great Books and the Great Conversation) with examples and reading lists posted publicly.
- Evidence of contemplative Pedagogy (Scholé), memorization/chanting practices, and opportunities for Socratic dialogue or seminars, including upper-level rhetoric or debate opportunities.
- Clear Faculty portraits as mentors and living exemplars and a described “faculty as living curriculum” model.
- Explicit, public partnerships with parents as co-educators, parent formation activities (book studies, lectures), and an open-visit policy for parents.

Citations informing the expected classical signals:

- Positive keywords and signals for religious/metaphysical foundations, purpose, and curriculum (as defined by the Six Essential Elements and the classical lexicon).
- Great-Books/Great-Conversation/Trivium/Quadrivium and the rest of the classical pedagogy vocabulary (as reflected in the classical lexicon and related documents).
- The Scholé/restful learning and liturgical/contemplative pedagogy references (The Scholé Way material).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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